I had gone through too much trauma on "—And Now You Don't" to continue the series. I had spent too much time, far too much, on working out twists in the plot that would fit what had gone before. I think that by this time even Campbell realized that I had had enough, though I'm sure that if he could have had his way, he would have had me work on the Foundation forever, since there was no question that the stories were crowd pleasers.

11

Even more exciting, in a way, was the news that Fred Pohl brought to me. Doubleday had considered "Grow Old with Me" and was willing to publish it as a book, provided I rewrote it and lengthened it from its 40,000 words to the full novel-length 70,000.

They were willing to pay me an option on it of $150, and I would be able to keep this option, even if my revision and lengthening proved unsuitable. What's more, if they liked the revision, they would pay me another $350 and then publish it as a book and pay me a royalty of 10 per cent of the royalties on all sales up to 5,000 and 12V2 per cent thereafter. Since the book would be priced at $2.50, that meant a whole silver quarter for every copy sold, and if more than 5,000 were sold, then $.3125 on every copy afterward.

This was a magnificent prospect, but I had grown cynical where "Grow Old with Me" was concerned. Somehow, I thought, it would manage to be rejected.

Well, I would take the option, so that the story would have earned something. I would then make the revision and we would see.

On March 31, Pohl handed me a check for $135. He kept $15 as agent's fee on the option. He was my agent once again, as he had been nine years before.

12

Finally, on April 4, I received a formal notification from Dean James Faulkner that I had been appointed an instructor in biochemistry at Boston University School of Medicine as of May 1, 1949.

Well, what could I do? I had been looking for a job madly for two months, and this was the only one that turned up and, except for the fact that it was in Boston, it was a satisfactory one. On April 5, I accepted officially and that meant farewell to Stuyvesant Town and, far worse, farewell to New York.